

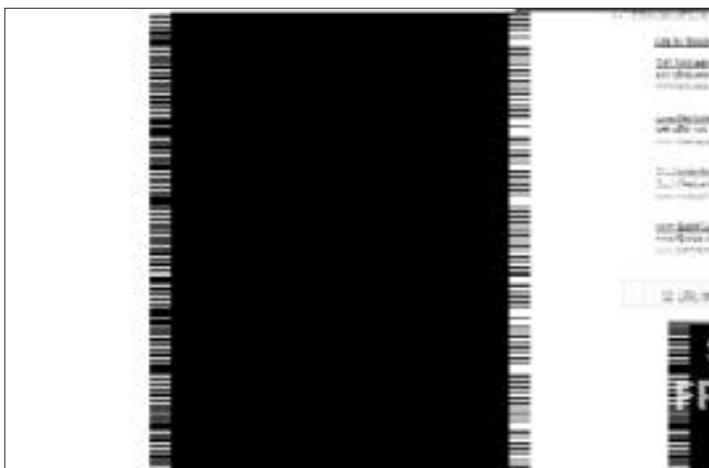
tion. This can range from text that is “hidden,” as for example, text coloured similar to the background, or by redirecting users from a page that is optimised for search engines to one that is more human-friendly. As a general rule, a method that sends a user to a page that is different from the page the search engine ranked is black hat.

Search engines can and do penalise sites they discover using black hat methods, either by reducing their rankings or eliminating their listings from their databases altogether. Such penalties can be applied either automatically by the search engines’ algorithms, or by a manual review of a site.

An infamous example is the February 2006 Google removal of both the BMW Germany and Ricoh Germany sites for use of deceptive practices. However, both companies quickly apologised, fixed the offending pages, and were restored to Google’s list.

6.1.2 Spamdexing

Another such method is known as spamdexing, or search engine spamming. This is the practice of creating Web pages that will be



This is a part of a lenthly scroll—so many advertisements!